



BALI OFF SCRIPT

The Bali Villa Build Guide

Zoning, permits, build costs and running costs: every question answered straight.

By Kai, Strategic Investment Adviser
balioffscript.com

How to use this guide. Every question buyers ask me about this topic, each with the short answer. The link under each one opens the full answer with the sources. Rules change: check the date on the page, and verify anything before you sign with your own notary, lawyer and tax consultant.

Building & Zoning

Zone colours, permits, the moratorium, and what it costs to build.

How much does it cost to build a villa in Bali?

Quotes run from IDR 6M to 15M per square metre. The spread is specification, and the number you are shown usually excludes the things that break the budget.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/cost-to-build-villa-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/cost-to-build-villa-bali/)

What do Bali's zoning colours mean, and how do you check properly?

Pink lets you rent. Yellow does not. Green gets demolished. Check it yourself before you pay anything.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/bali-zoning-colours/](https://balioffscript.com/building/bali-zoning-colours/)

How much does a swimming pool cost in Bali?

A standard villa pool runs USD 15,000 to 25,000 to build. The part owners underestimate is what it costs every month after that.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/swimming-pool-cost-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/swimming-pool-cost-bali/)

What happens if you buy a villa built without a PBG?

No licence, no legal rental, and exposure to sealing or demolition. It is more common than the market admits.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/pbg-slf-building-permits/](https://balioffscript.com/building/pbg-slf-building-permits/)

What are KDB and KLB, and why do they decide your project?

Zoning tells you if you can build. KDB and KLB tell you how much. A plot can be perfectly legal and still economically pointless.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/kdb-klb-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/kdb-klb-bali/)

What are the real risks of buying off-plan in Bali?

You are paying for something that does not exist yet, on permits that may not exist either. Here is what to verify before the first instalment.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/off-plan-villa-bali-risk/](https://balioffscript.com/building/off-plan-villa-bali-risk/)

How long does it take to get a PBG on empty land in Bali?

Up to six months from bare land to building approval, and the regency you are in changes the answer by months.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/pbg-process-empty-land/](https://balioffscript.com/building/pbg-process-empty-land/)

Can you legalise a Bali villa that was built without permits?

Often yes, through retroactive PBG and SLF. It takes eight months to a year and it is not guaranteed.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/legalise-villa-without-permit/](https://balioffscript.com/building/legalise-villa-without-permit/)

What is it really like to build a villa in Bali?

The permit sequence, the timeline by regency, and the parts of the process people do not budget for.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/build-a-villa-in-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/build-a-villa-in-bali/)

Where does a Bali villa get its water?

Piped supply does not reach everywhere, wells need permits, and on the Bukit water is a genuine operating cost rather than a detail.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/water-supply-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/water-supply-bali-villa/)

Should you renovate a villa in Bali?

Older stock is cheap for a reason. Renovation can be the best value in the market or a way to buy someone else's permit problem.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/renovating-villa-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/renovating-villa-bali/)

What does it cost to furnish a villa in Bali?

Furniture is cheap and good here. What owners get wrong is how fast it wears out and how rarely it is included in a build quote.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/furniture-fit-out-cost-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/furniture-fit-out-cost-bali/)

Is solar worth it for a Bali villa?

The sunshine is excellent and the electricity bill is large, which makes the arithmetic better here than in most places owners come from.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/solar-power-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/solar-power-bali-villa/)

How do you choose a developer in Bali?

Renders are free. What separates a developer worth paying is what they have finished, who they finished it for, and what they hold if it goes wrong.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/how-to-choose-bali-developer/](https://balioffscript.com/building/how-to-choose-bali-developer/)

Should you buy off-plan or completed in Bali?

Off-plan promises a discount and delivers construction risk, counterparty risk and a building nobody has inspected. Completed costs more and exists.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/off-plan-vs-completed-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/off-plan-vs-completed-bali/)

What should you check at villa handover?

The last moment you have leverage is before you accept the building. After that, every defect is a favour you are asking for.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/villa-handover-checklist/](https://balioffscript.com/building/villa-handover-checklist/)

What permits do you need to build on leased land in Bali?

The permit is applied for in the landowner's name in most cases, which means your right to build has to be written into the lease before you sign it.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/permits-to-build-on-leased-land-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/permits-to-build-on-leased-land-bali/)

What are the building rules in Bali?

Height limits, setbacks, coverage ratios and local custom all constrain what you can build, and the customary rules are not written in the spatial plan.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/construction-rules-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/construction-rules-bali/)

Do you need an architect to build in Bali?

The design decides your build cost, your permit and your nightly rate. It is the cheapest part of the project and the one people cut.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/hiring-an-architect-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/hiring-an-architect-bali/)

How do you deal with termites and pests in a Bali villa?

Termites destroy timber structures here faster than owners expect, and treatment before building costs a fraction of repair afterwards.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/termites-pests-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/termites-pests-bali-villa/)

What does it cost to build on a slope in Bali?

Sloped land is cheaper per are and more expensive to build on. Retaining, foundations and access frequently cost more than the land discount saved.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/building-on-a-slope-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/building-on-a-slope-bali/)

How should you contract a builder in Bali?

There is no licensing regime and no statutory warranty. Whatever protection you have is in the contract you signed and the money you have not yet paid.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/contractor-contract-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/contractor-contract-bali/)

How does wastewater work in a Bali villa?

There is no mains sewer across most of Bali. Every villa treats its own wastewater, and a failed system is the worst problem a rental property can have.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/septic-wastewater-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/septic-wastewater-bali-villa/)

How should you specify aircon for a Bali villa?

Aircon is the largest running cost and the most common guest complaint. Both are specification problems rather than operating problems.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/aircon-specification-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/aircon-specification-bali-villa/)

What does landscaping a Bali villa cost?

The garden is a large part of what a Bali villa sells on, it is routinely omitted from build quotes, and it is the cheapest thing that changes a nightly rate.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/landscaping-garden-cost-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/landscaping-garden-cost-bali/)

Does a Bali villa need backup power?

Outages happen, more in the wet season and more in some areas. For a property with paying guests, four hours without power is a review.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/generator-backup-power-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/generator-backup-power-bali/)

Should you build in bamboo in Bali?

Bamboo buildings are spectacular, genuinely sustainable and considerably more demanding to own than the photographs suggest.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/bamboo-construction-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/bamboo-construction-bali/)

How should you design a Bali villa interior?

The interior is what the photographs sell and what guests review. Two constraints run through every decision: humidity and the camera.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/villa-interior-design-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/villa-interior-design-bali/)

What roof should a Bali villa have?

The roof decides how the villa photographs, how much it costs to maintain and how often you replace it. The popular choice is the shortest-lived.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/roof-types-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/roof-types-bali-villa/)

How long does it take to build a villa in Bali?

Six to twelve months of construction, eighteen to twenty-four from land to first guest, and the pauses are not the contractor's fault.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/build-programme-timeline-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/build-programme-timeline-bali/)

How do you build a sustainable villa in Bali?

Most of what reduces environmental impact here also reduces your running costs. The rest is expensive signalling.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/eco-sustainable-villa-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/eco-sustainable-villa-bali/)

Do you need a quantity surveyor in Bali?

Someone independent has to price the work, check what was built and verify what you pay for. Without that, the contractor is marking their own homework.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/quantity-surveyor-bali-build/](https://balioffscript.com/building/quantity-surveyor-bali-build/)

How should you design outdoor space in a Bali villa?

Guests spend most of their time outside. The outdoor space is where the rate is set and where most villas underinvest.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/outdoor-living-design-bali/](https://balioffscript.com/building/outdoor-living-design-bali/)

How should you design a Bali villa kitchen?

Families and groups cook, which makes the kitchen a genuine booking differentiator. It is also where humidity destroys the wrong specification fastest.

[Full answer: balioffscript.com/building/kitchen-design-bali-villa/](https://balioffscript.com/building/kitchen-design-bali-villa/)

Want a second pair of eyes?

I look at deals before people sign: the documents, the zoning, the lease and the numbers.
Message me with what you are looking at.

[WhatsApp Kai](#) · [balioffscript.com](#)